Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:
a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength
9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level
11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:
- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their sit. Double, then bid notrump.

Responding to a Takeout Double
0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible
9-11 points, jump in your best suit
12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit